

SORT

1 / 30

ENTRYWAY

Landing Zone

Empty the tray and the paper stack onto the floor. Keys that open nothing, loyalty cards, dead batteries and last month's flyers leave now. Every piece of mail gets a verdict of act, file, or recycle before anything goes back on the surface.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STRAIGHTEN

2 / 30

ENTRYWAY

Landing Zone

Put the tray where your hand actually opens on the way in, not where the furniture happens to be. Keys and sunglasses in the tray, one upright folder for act-on paper, and the charger plugged in at the far end away from anything that drips.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SHINE

3 / 30

ENTRYWAY

Landing Zone

Lift the tray out and wipe under it, then wipe the tray itself. Keys shed grit and coins leave a grey film that tells you exactly how long it has been since anyone did this.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY

4 / 30

ENTRYWAY

Landing Zone

The charging cable and the umbrella drip line must not share a spot. Check what else is on the outlet feeding the dock, because a lamp, a seasonal heater and a four-port charger on one strip is this room's usual overload.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STANDARDIZE

5 / 30

ENTRYWAY

Landing Zone

Photograph the cleared tray with the folder standing beside it, print it small, and tape it inside the coat cupboard door at the height people glance while hanging a coat. The tray then teaches itself.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SUSTAIN

6 / 30

ENTRYWAY

Landing Zone

When you sit down after dinner, the folder comes with you and you work it one sheet at a time until it stands loose and upright again.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SORT

7 / 30

ENTRYWAY

Coat and Outerwear Zone

Take every coat down. Anything that did not go outdoors once through the last cold season leaves, and so do the single gloves you kept in case the other one turned up. Off-season coats go to a bedroom closet, not to the far end of the same rail.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STRAIGHTEN

8 / 30

ENTRYWAY

Coat and Outerwear Zone

Hooks for what goes on and off daily, hangers only for the wool coat that creases. Set the lowest hook at the height of the shortest person who uses it, and keep the two hooks nearest the door empty for visitors.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SHINE

9 / 30

ENTRYWAY

Coat and Outerwear Zone

Brush the shoulders of the hanging coats, wipe the shelf where dust settles on top of the hat bin, and tip out the umbrella stand. There is always water and grit in the bottom of it.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY

10 / 30

ENTRYWAY**Coat and Outerwear Zone**

Hang your full weight on each hook before you trust it with a soaked winter coat. Hooks driven into plasterboard without an anchor pull out later, with the coat still attached and a lump of wall behind it.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STANDARDIZE

11 / 30

ENTRYWAY**Coat and Outerwear Zone**

Write the contents and the season on the shelf bin, hats and gloves, winter, so whoever reaches up for it in October knows without opening the lid whether they have the right bin.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SUSTAIN

12 / 30

ENTRYWAY**Coat and Outerwear Zone**

When you put a wash on, walk the rail on your way past and return anything that has been left over a chair back or the bannister.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SORT

13 / 30

ENTRYWAY**Shoe and Boot Zone**

Pull every shoe out and pair them up on the floor. Odd shoes, outgrown children's pairs and the trainers with the split sole all go, and so does the tin of polish that has dried solid.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STRAIGHTEN

14 / 30

ENTRYWAY**Shoe and Boot Zone**

Daily pairs on the rack at a height you can reach standing up, boots in the tray because they will always come in wet, off-season pairs boxed in a closet. Nothing at all on the floor between the door and the rack.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SHINE

15 / 30

ENTRYWAY**Shoe and Boot Zone**

Take the boot tray outside and hose it. The salt and grit sitting in it is precisely what scratches your hallway floor. Wipe down the rack shelves too, they hold more dried mud than they look like they do.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY

16 / 30

ENTRYWAY**Shoe and Boot Zone**

Wet soles on a hard floor are how people go down in this room. The tray has to catch the drip, and anything that walked in soaked stays on the tray until it is dry rather than being carried through the house.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STANDARDIZE

17 / 30

ENTRYWAY**Shoe and Boot Zone**

Give each person their own named shelf on the rack, the name written at the shelf edge, so a third pair has visibly nowhere to stand and nobody has to count.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SUSTAIN

18 / 30

ENTRYWAY**Shoe and Boot Zone**

Shoes come off just inside the door and go onto the rack before the coat comes off, while your hands are still free.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SORT ENTRYWAY Entry Console or Bench Tip the drawer out onto the bench. Dead batteries, pens that do not write, single earbuds, sunscreen from three summers ago and takeaway menus all go now. Anything you would not want while wearing your outdoor shoes belongs in a different room. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN ENTRYWAY Entry Console or Bench Divide the drawer into named sections and hold to them: dog lead and waste bags, sun cream and insect spray, a torch, one pen. Bags and the vacuum go underneath the bench, never on the seat. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE ENTRYWAY Entry Console or Bench Take the drawer fully out and tip the sand and crumbs out of its corners. Wipe the seat itself, which collects the same grit as the floor because people sit on it in outdoor clothes. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SAFETY ENTRYWAY Entry Console or Bench Fix the console to the wall if it is taller than it is deep, because children climb open drawer fronts like a ladder. Move the box cutter and the scissors out of the shallow drawer that opens at toddler head height. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE ENTRYWAY Entry Console or Bench Write the three permitted top items on a card and tape it inside the drawer, so the cap survives everyone who did not read this book. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN ENTRYWAY Entry Console or Bench When you clear the dinner table, carry the plates past the bench and take the top back down to three on the way through. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SORT ENTRYWAY Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor Nothing is stored on this patch of floor, so the recycling bag, the parcel waiting to go back and the sports kit all move tonight. Give outgoing returns one named spot in another room and carry the rest to where they actually belong. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN ENTRYWAY Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor Two mats and only two. Coarse outside to scrape, absorbent inside to dry. The inside mat needs to be long enough that both feet land on it while walking, and most are not, which is exactly how the grit gets past. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE ENTRYWAY Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor Vacuum the inside mat on both faces, then take it outdoors, beat it and wash it. Run a cloth along the bottom edge of the door and along the threshold strip, because that dark line is all the grit the mat never caught. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

ENTRYWAY

Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor

A curled mat corner and a mat that slides on hard floor are the two ways this threshold puts somebody down. Grip or tape the edges flat, and dry the floor immediately when someone comes in soaked rather than leaving it to evaporate.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

ENTRYWAY

Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor

Run a thin line of tape around where the mat should sit, so a mat kicked out of position is obvious to anyone walking in rather than only to you.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

ENTRYWAY

Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor

The mat is on your route back to the cupboard with the vacuum, so it gets done last, every time, as part of putting the vacuum away.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

The standards that keep these zones

ENTRYWAY · LANDING ZONE

The surface holds the tray and the folder and nothing else, and keys never ride out of the house in a coat pocket that lives on a hanger.

As you take your coat off, your hands are already full and already stopped. That is the moment everything in them goes into the tray.

ENTRYWAY · COAT AND OUTERWEAR ZONE

Two empty hooks at all times. If there is no empty hook, one coat is in the wrong room.

On the first morning cold enough that you go looking for gloves, that is the seasonal swap. Do it that morning, standing there, rather than noting it for later.

ENTRYWAY · SHOE AND BOOT ZONE

Two pairs per person at the door, soles down, everything else lives somewhere that is not the entryway.

On the night the bins go out, the boot tray goes out with them and comes back empty.

ENTRYWAY · ENTRY CONSOLE OR BENCH

Three items on the top, an empty seat, and every drawer section holding one named category.

You already open this drawer to put the dog lead back after a walk. While it is open, glance at the top and take it back to three.

ENTRYWAY · DOOR, MAT, AND IMMEDIATE FLOOR

Nothing is stored on the floor inside the door's swing, ever, and both mats lie flat inside their taped outline.

Whoever comes home last and locks the door straightens the mat with a foot before turning the key.